27-Question Seller Call Script

Property: _____

Date: _____

Part B: First contact.

Takes in: a passing AS-02 screen

Hands to: AS-05, AS-06, AS-07

The first call is not a pitch. It is an interview. You are screening the seller, not the park. In a mom-and-pop deal the seller is the disclosure system: what they volunteer, what they dodge, and what they change the subject to is the diligence. Tag every answer V, B, M, A, C, or U. Unverified is worth $0.

LISTEN FOR IT. Numbers that change between sentences. Hurry signals. Health or family words. Pride in the park: legacy can matter more than price. What they joke about is what they will not say straight.

How to run the call

- Open with gratitude, then hand them the mic. Target: they talk 70% of the time.
- Silence is a tool. Ask, then count to six before you fill it.
- Recording consent laws vary by state, confirm with your attorney. Default to notes.

1. The owner

#	Ask	Capture + status
1	How did you come to own the park? How long?	
2	After the sale, what does your life look like?	

2. The park

#	Ask	Capture + status
3	Lot mix: tenant-owned, park-owned, vacant?	
4	Lot rent today? When did it last change?	
5	Occupancy now vs. a year ago? Who collects, how?	
6	Manager on site? What do they do all day?	

3. The numbers

#	Ask	Capture + status
7	Last 12 months collected revenue, not billed?	
8	Three biggest expenses? Who pays utilities?	
9	Property taxes last year? Assessed value?	
10	Insurance cost? Claims in the last five years?	
11	Debt on the park? Balance and payment?	
12	How does cash move here? Anything outside the bank?	

Question 12 sits last in the numbers on purpose: ask it early and the call can end.

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4. Infrastructure and regulators

#	Ask	Capture + status
13	Water: well, municipal, or private system?	
14	Wastewater: septic, lagoon, plant, or city?	
15	Which permits and licenses? All current?	
16	Any letters from the county, state, or EPA, ever?	
17	Age of water and sewer lines? Backups or boil notices?	
18	Electric: submetered or master meter? Who pays?	
19	Roads: who maintains? How are they after rain?	
20	Buried tanks, old dumps, pre-1976 homes?	

5. The homes

#	Ask	Capture + status
21	Park-owned homes: how many? Titles in your name?	
22	Liens on any of the homes?	
23	Sell the homes with the park, or keep renting?	

6. The deal

#	Ask	Capture + status
24	Why sell now? What changed?	
25	Price in mind? How did you get there?	
26	Would you carry a note? What terms do you need?	
27	Timeline? What happens if it does not sell?	

Front: page 1 is questions 1 to 12. Page 2 is questions 13 to 27, branches, outcomes, debrief.

Motivation branches: what to emphasize

- Estate: they need a clean close. Emphasize all cash, as-is, one signing.
- Burnout: they need no more 2 a.m. calls. Emphasize a fast handoff, keep their manager.
- Health: they need speed and simplicity. Emphasize short diligence, few contingencies.
- Taxes: they need to spread the gain. Emphasize an installment note, mind the timing.
- Family conflict: they need one decision, no drama. One point of contact, clear splits.
- Tired of tenants: they need the headaches gone. Emphasize a transition plan, retain staff.

Three required outcomes of call one

- ☐ Motivation type identified and written down.
- ☐ Document list agreed. Send the Evidence-Request List (AS-06) within 48 hours.
- ☐ Next call date on the calendar before you hang up.

90-second debrief, right after you hang up

Three things I heard: _____ **One thing they avoided:** _____

Motivation type: _____ **Next step and date:** _____

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Worked example: Maple Bend Estates (fictional)

The call ran 34 minutes. The seller talked roughly 24 of them: 24 / 34 = 70.6%, on target. Capture excerpts:

Q	Answer	Status
3, mix	44 occupied, 4 vacant	B at first
4, rent	$410 lot rent, raised 2024	B
7, revenue	'About $190k collected'	B; bank says $189,000
13, water	Well, 'never had a problem'	B
15, permits	Could not name the septic permit	M
2, after	Wants out before winter, knees going	Health pressure, B

Outcomes: motivation typed as burnout with health pressure. Documents agreed: 12 months of bank statements and utility bills, due Friday. Next call: Tuesday, 10 a.m. The walk later found 41 occupied, 3 derelict counted as occupied, 4 vacant: 41 + 3 + 4 = 48. The B on question 3 became an M, then a finding. The call did its job.

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The Doctrine

The belief this shatters: the first call screens the park. It screens the seller. In a mom-and-pop deal the person is the disclosure system, and the call is the only time you hear them unguarded. What they volunteer, what they dodge, and what they change the subject to is the diligence. The rule: they talk seventy percent of the time. You are the interviewer, not the pitcher. Ask, then count to six. Write down the motivation type before you hang up, agree on the documents, and set the next call date. A call with no next date is a call that never happened.

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